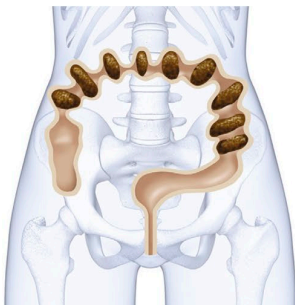


COLONIC MOVEMENT

The colon has three bands of muscle called taenia coli, which form pouches called haustra (see p.225). Muscular movements mix and propel faeces towards the rectum. The motion of faeces varies in rate, intensity, and nature, depending mainly on the stage of digestion of the contents. The three main types of motion are known as segmentation, peristaltic contractions, and mass movements. Faecal material passes more slowly through the colon than through the small intestine, enabling the reabsorption into the blood of up to 2 litres ($4\frac{1}{4}$ pints) of water every day.

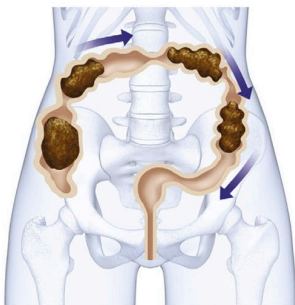
SEGMENTATION

A series of ring-like contractions occurs at regular intervals. These churn and mix faeces but do not propel them along the colon.



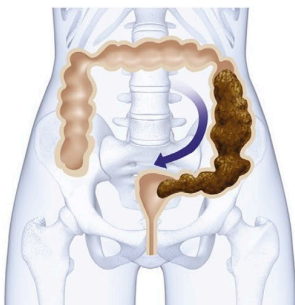
PERISTALTIC CONTRACTIONS

Small waves of movement called peristaltic contractions (see p.218) propel faeces toward the rectum. The muscles behind the contents contract, while those in front relax.



MASS MOVEMENTS

These extra-strong peristaltic waves move from the middle of the transverse colon. They happen two or three times a day and drive faeces into the rectum.



Ascending colon

Caecum

Appendix

THE RECTUM

The rectum is a passageway for faeces and is normally empty, except just before and during defecation.